

Week 4 of Blessed to be a Blessing– November 23, 2025

I. Welcome!

If you are a first-time guest or you are wanting to plug in more to weekly virtual prayer meetings, our Wednesday night small groups, serving, or membership–*Fill out our digital connect card to stay connected!*



II. Announcements:

Bless the Nations Prayer Sunday will be hosted Next week: November 30

Prayer Update: During Thanksgiving week, 12:30 pm prayer meetings will be held Monday and Tuesday but will not be held Wednesday through Friday.

III. Possessing the Gates: God's Heart for the Nations, Hazen Stevens

I. INTRO — A Promise Bigger Than We Realized

God blessed Abraham so all peoples would be blessed. After Isaac, God expanded it: *“your offspring shall possess the gate of his enemies.”*

- In Christ, we are Abraham's descendants.
- Abraham believed the shadow; we believe the substance.
- This promise is part of our calling.

II. FROM PROMISE TO COMMISSION

Jesus ties Abraham's promise to the church: *“the gates of hell will not prevail.”*

- Matthew 28 sends us to all nations.
- Acts 1:8 moves us from Jerusalem to the ends of the earth.
- This is our assignment.

III. TO THE UTTERMOST — Geography & History

Eschatos means both the **uttermost place** and the **last time**.

- The mission reaches every place and every generation.
- Abraham → Christ → the church → us → future generations.

IV. THE LARGER STORY

We have promises we didn't know we had. The American dream is too small.

- Abraham saw only a part; fulfillment continues through us.
- Our witness matters now and for generations.

V. PERSONAL STORY — THE HILLSIDE

On a hillside in Moyale, overlooking the Garre—no Bible, no believers—God broke my heart.

- A Kenyan missionary prayed weekly for them.
- I prayed, “Send me.”
- God said, *“I’m sending you to start a church in Buckhead that will not forget the unreached.”*

VI. THE CURRENT REALITY

3.2 billion people are unreached—never hearing of Jesus.

- Less than 1% of mission funding reaches them.
- Hard soil and slow results don’t diminish the call—Jesus started with 12.

VII. HOW TO OPEN YOUR HEART

Open your heart to God’s heart for the nations.

- **Pray** for unreached peoples and neighbors.
- **Serve** locally and globally.
- **Give** to missions and Bible translation.
- **Form** disciples.
- **Reach** by going or welcoming those God sends.

VIII. YOUVERSION — A BILLION REASONS TO CELEBRATE

YouVersion passed one billion downloads—every country on earth.

- No ads, no monetization, ever.
- Our content reaches nations we’ll never see.
- When we open our hearts, God opens doors.

IX. CONCLUSION — GOD WILL OPEN DOORS

As we PRAY, SERVE, GIVE, FORM, and REACH—locally and globally—God will open doors we couldn’t anticipate.

- We are links in the chain from Abraham to Christ’s return.
- Witnesses in space (nations) and time (generations).

Call to Action:

What step will you take this week?